

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 19, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 43:1–12

1 Afterward he brought me to the gate, the gate that faces toward the east.

2 And behold, the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the east. His voice was like the sound of many waters; and the earth shone with His glory.

3 It was like the appearance of the vision which I saw—like the vision which I saw when I came to destroy the city. The visions were like the vision which I saw by the River Chebar; and I fell on my face.

4 And the glory of the LORD came into the temple by way of the gate which faces toward the east.

5 The Spirit lifted me up and brought me into the inner court; and behold, the glory of the LORD filled the temple.

6 Then I heard Him speaking to me from the temple, while a man stood beside me.

7 And He said to me, "Son of man, this is the place of My throne and the place of the soles of My feet, where I will dwell in the midst of the children of Israel forever. No more shall the house of Israel defile My holy name, they nor their kings, by their harlotry or with the carcasses of their kings on their high places.

8 When they set their threshold by My threshold, and their doorpost by My doorpost, with a wall between them and Me, they defiled My holy name by the abominations which they committed; therefore I have consumed them in My anger.

9 Now let them put their harlotry and the carcasses of their kings far away from Me, and I will dwell in their midst forever.

10 "Son of man, describe the temple to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities; and let them measure the pattern.

11 And if they are ashamed of all that they have done, make known to them the design of the temple and its arrangement, its exits and its entrances, its entire design and all its

ordinances, all its forms and all its laws. Write it down in their sight, so that they may keep its whole design and all its ordinances, and perform them.

12 This is the law of the temple: The whole area surrounding the mountaintop is most holy. Behold, this is the law of the temple.

II. Key Summary

- Ezekiel is brought to the gate facing east and sees the glory of the God of Israel coming from the east, with a voice like the sound of many waters and the earth shining with His glory; it reminds him of the vision he saw by the River Chebar, and he falls on his face.
 - The glory of the LORD comes into the temple through the east gate, the Spirit lifts Ezekiel into the inner court, and the glory fills the temple.
 - God speaks from the temple, calling it the place of His throne and the place of the soles of His feet where He will dwell among Israel forever, and tells Ezekiel to describe the temple's design and laws to the house of Israel so that they may be ashamed of their iniquities.
-

III. Passage Analysis

The glory comes back through the gate it left by

From the same direction Ezekiel saw God's glory depart, so now in his vision he saw it come to this new temple. Without the glory of the God of Israel, Ezekiel's temple was nothing more than a building. With the glory of God, it was a sacred place, a habitation for God and the radiance of His presence. [1]

Nineteen years earlier Ezekiel had watched God's glory leave the defiled temple through the east gate (Ezekiel 8:1; 10:18-19; 11:23); in this vision (Ezekiel 40:1) he watches it return the same way. God picks the very same gate, as if to say that the relationship broken back then is one He is coming back to restore Himself.

Seeing God's plan is what shows them the road they walked

"Make known to the people the new Temple and its appointments," so that they may repent of their evil doings once they have seen God's gracious purposes. [2]

God has Ezekiel spell out the temple's design to Israel so "that they may be ashamed of their iniquities." Their shame comes from finally seeing the good thing God had in mind for them, and realizing what they threw away.

IV. Reflection Question

Before God says He is moving in, He first tells them to move some things out. If God were moving into your life, what do you think He would ask you to move out first? Would you be willing?

God tells Israel, "Now let them put their harlotry and the carcasses of their kings far away from Me, and I will dwell in their midst forever" (43:9). Making room and God moving in are one and the same thing here.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 43,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-43/>

[2] BibleHub, Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers (Ezekiel 43:10),
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/43-10.htm>